

AI Chat Proxy — Configuration and Environment

Project: AI Chat Proxy

Technology: JavaScript, Node.js, Express, OpenAI API

Location: /home/dominic/Documents/ai-chat-proxy

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Environment Variables

```
OPENAI_API_KEY=sk-...  
PORT=3000  
RATE_LIMIT_WINDOW=60000  
RATE_LIMIT_MAX=20
```

Configuration & Environment

Environment Files

```
# .env (example)  
DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///./data.db  
SECRET_KEY=your-secret-key-here  
DEBUG=false  
CORS_ORIGINS=*
```

Configuration Loading

```
# Pattern used across projects  
from pydantic_settings import BaseSettings  
  
class Settings(BaseSettings):  
    database_url: str = "sqlite:///./data.db"  
    secret_key: str = "change-me"  
    debug: bool = False  
    cors_origins: str = "*"   
  
    model_config = {"env_file": ".env", "env_file_encoding": "utf-8"}
```

Runtime Configuration

Parameter	Source	Default	Description
DATABASE_URL	.env	sqlite:///./data.db	DB connection
SECRET_KEY	.env	(required)	JWT signing
DEBUG	.env	false	Dev mode
CORS_ORIGINS	.env	*	CORS policy

Deployment-Specific Config

Render Web Service (free tier): - CPU: Shared - RAM: 512 MB - Disk: 1 GB - Region: Frankfurt - Auto-deploy: On push to main

Sensitive Values

Variable	Risk	Mitigation
SECRET_KEY	JWT forgery	Use strong random value, rotate periodically
OPENAI_API_KEY	Cost, data exposure	Server-side only, rate-limited
DATABASE_URL	Data access	Never commit to git